MODULE 2

CHAPTER 7

Getting Started with Agentic AI

Chapter 6 established that AI success is ultimately a leadership and change challenge. This chapter turns that mindset into action: how to get started with agentic AI by aligning it to your business objectives, mapping the KPIs that matter to the right AI capabilities, and building the data discipline that makes every stage of the journey work.

For communication service providers, getting started with agentic AI is less about chasing the newest technology and more about making deliberate choices. The leaders who succeed begin with business objectives, identify the KPIs that matter most, and then map those outcomes to the AI capabilities that can actually move the needle. At every step, clean and connected data is what turns promise into performance. When the information agents rely on is fragmented, inconsistent, or outdated, they don't solve problems — they scale them. When data is accurate, current, and ready to use, agentic AI amplifies good decisions and makes them faster, more consistent, and more confident.

What do we mean by "clean data"? Clean data is accurate, complete, consistently formatted, and up to date. It means subscriber records that reflect reality, knowledge articles that aren't contradictory or stale, and business rules that are documented rather than tribal. Clean data is the difference between an agent that gives a confident, correct answer and one that confidently gives the wrong one.

What You'll Learn

- How data quality requirements evolve across the three stages of the Agentic AI Journey
- Why each stage breaks down without intentional data discipline — and how to prevent it
- How to build enrichment habits that support scale before you need them
- Map business objectives and KPIs to the right starting agent

The Agentic AI Journey

The Agentic AI Journey moves through three stages, and each one raises the bar for data quality. Think of it as climbing a staircase: each step up requires stronger data underneath. At the first step, poor data leads to a bad answer — a human catches it and moves on. At the second step, that same bad data triggers a bad action, repeated at automation speed. At the third step, it cascades across agents and departments before anyone notices. Skip the discipline early and you may still get a pilot off the ground — but you will not be able to scale it.

1 2 3

Knowledge Assist

Answer This Question

Agents enable your marketing, support, and operations teams to find answers more quickly and learn faster. Instead of searching through outdated documents or waiting for a colleague, employees ask and get an immediate, grounded answer.

Data Enrichment
When knowledge sources are accurate and current, agents deliver consistent answers. Every thumbs-up/down interaction surfaces gaps and drives continuous improvement.

Employee Experience
Teams stop searching and start asking. New hires ramp faster. Experienced staff spend less time answering the same questions repeatedly.

FOUNDATION

Task Automation

Do This Task

Agents carry out tasks to meet defined goals and rules — to resolve issues, build segments, and trigger workflows — improving speed of execution and leveraging insights from past interactions.

Data Enrichment
When historical data is clean and rules are well defined, agents resolve issues correctly the first time. Each resolved interaction becomes training data.

Employee Experience
Repetitive, low-judgment tasks are handled by agents. Staff focus on exceptions, escalations, and work that requires human judgment.

AUTOMATED

Process Orchestration

Run This Process

Agents react to events, anticipate needs, and coordinate with other agents to complete complex tasks autonomously — across departments, systems, and workflows.

Data Enrichment
When data definitions are consistent across domains, agents hand off cleanly to one another — enabling fully autonomous cross-system workflows.

Employee Experience
Staff shift from executing processes to overseeing them. They intervene on exceptions. Agents handle the rest.

ENTERPRISE-SCALE

Key Point: The organizations that invest in data quality habits at Stage 1 are the ones that will be ready to operate at enterprise scale by Stage 3. Those that wait will find themselves rebuilding foundations under pressure.

Knowledge Enrichment

On Day 1 of any agent implementation, your knowledge base is at its weakest. This is not a failure — it is how agent systems work. They are designed to learn and improve through use, but only when they are fed accurate, current, and well-structured knowledge. Without intentional enrichment, agents learn faster from outdated information, amplifying the very problems you hoped they would solve.

Key Insight: Think of knowledge enrichment not as a one-time cleanup project, but as an ongoing discipline — like maintaining a garden. The work is never done, but the rewards grow with each passing season.

Effective Enrichment Practices

Building a sustainable knowledge enrichment process does not require massive infrastructure or specialized teams. It requires commitment to a handful of simple, repeatable practices that prevent confusion from creeping back in and ensure agent outputs remain credible as usage expands.

1

Clear Ownership of Key Data Domains

Assign named owners for each critical knowledge area. When everyone is responsible, no one is responsible. Ownership creates accountability and ensures someone is actively watching for drift.

2

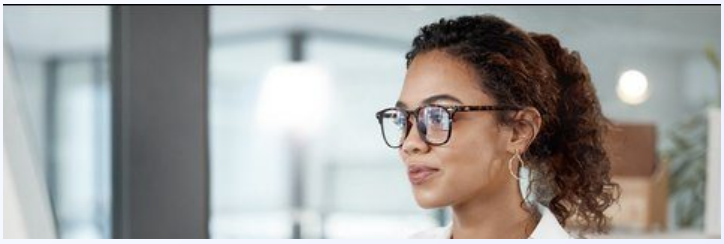
Simple Naming and Documentation Standards

Establish consistent conventions so that knowledge articles, data fields, and processes are easy to find and understand. Complexity is the enemy of adoption.

3

Lightweight Monthly or Quarterly Review Cadence

Schedule regular check-ins to verify accuracy, retire outdated content, and surface gaps. A short, recurring review beats an annual overhaul every time.



4

Freshness Dates and Archiving Policies

Tag content with "last verified" dates and set clear rules for when material should be reviewed, updated, or removed. Stale information is worse than no information—it erodes trust.

Aligning AI to Your Business Objectives

With multiple agentic workflows available, strong leaders don't start by asking which features are ready — they start with business priorities. The goal is to find the intersection of where your organization most needs to improve, where the data already supports action, and where your teams are ready to move.

1
STEP

Start with Business Priorities

Ground your conversation in financial reality. Where is cost highest? Where is revenue most constrained? Where do manual processes consume the most labor? Agentic AI should tie directly to lines on the P&L — not exist as a technology project in isolation.

ASK YOUR LEADERSHIP TEAM

→ How are we measuring success today?

→ What is our top priority this year?

2
STEP

Identify the KPI That Matters Most

Once you've located the business pressure point, name the specific metric. Is it subscriber churn rate? Mean time to repair? Cost per truck roll? Marketing conversion rate? A sharp KPI gives your agentic initiative a clear target — and makes it easy to demonstrate progress to your board and executive team.

ASK YOUR LEADERSHIP TEAM

→ Where does performance tend to drift?

→ When something goes wrong, how quickly do we know and act?

3
STEP

Map the AI Capability That Can Influence It

With a KPI in hand, work backward to identify which agent or combination of agents can realistically move that number. This step should involve both your AI leadership team and operational leads — it bridges strategy and execution, ensuring the capability you deploy is connected to the outcome you're chasing.

ASK YOUR LEADERSHIP TEAM

→ Which agents align to this KPI?

→ Is our data ready enough to act — or close to it?

Chapter Takeaway

Data quality is one of the few levers every organization can fully control. Agentic AI — from Knowledge Assist to Task Automation to Process Orchestration — only delivers its promise when data quality keeps pace at every stage. Treat knowledge enrichment as an ongoing leadership discipline, not a technical chore, and each stage of agent maturity will compound the last.

In the next chapter, we will explore how to measure AI progress and demonstrate ROI — giving your leadership team the evidence it needs to sustain momentum and justify continued investment.